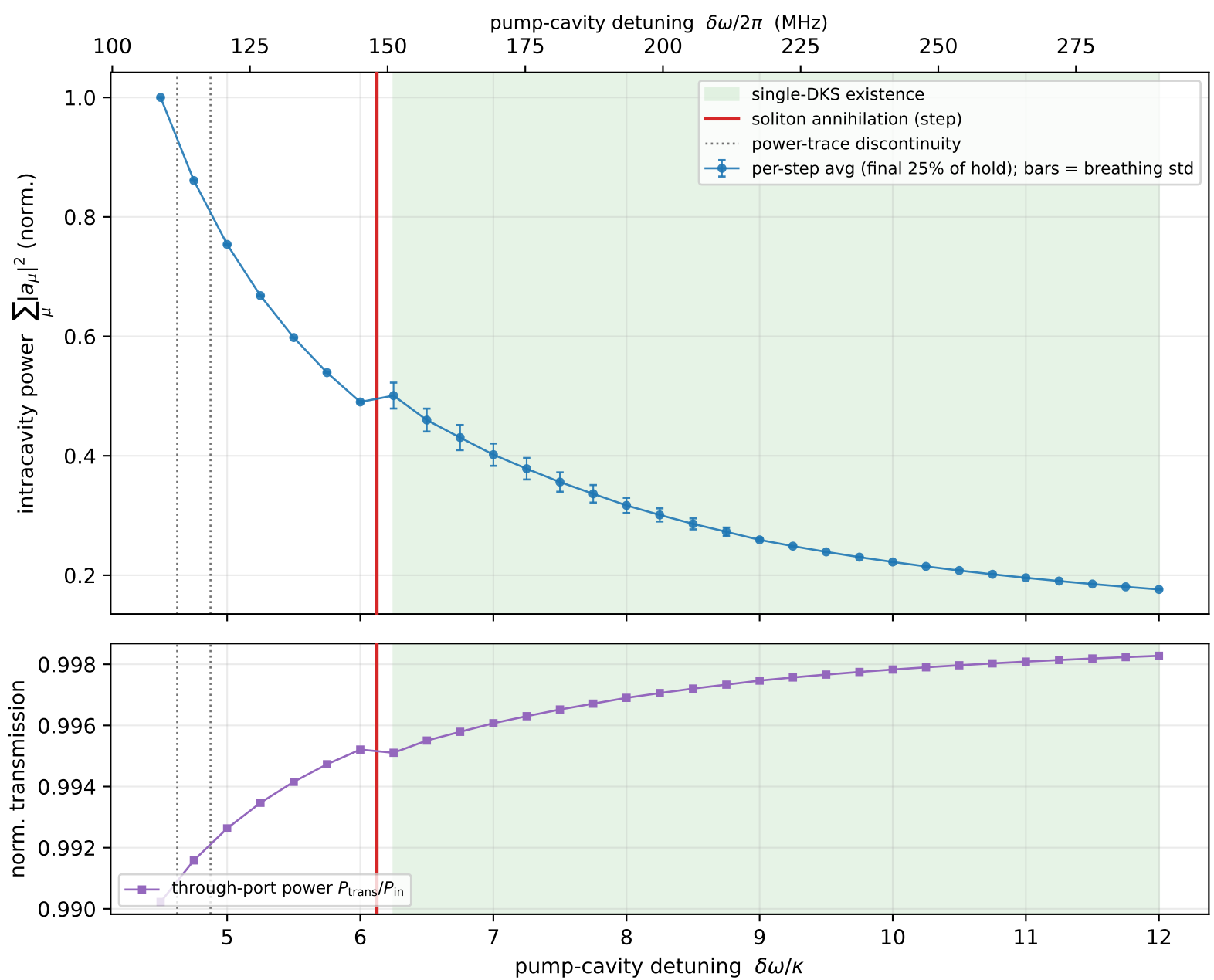




Single-DKS branch, $p_{\text{in}} = 0.214$ W, $n_{\text{tau}} = 4096$. Warm continuation, seeded at 12κ , swept DOWN, hold 2000 RT/step, averaged over the final 25% (cycle-averages the breather). Thermo-optic model ON (deterministic, noise off). Green = single-DKS existence region; the soliton annihilates (step) at its lower edge, where the breathing error bars collapse. Intracavity power normalised to the sweep max; transmission to the cold-cavity level. Dotted lines mark first-difference discontinuities of the power trace, which here fall on the near-resonance MI/CW rise, not the soliton step.